

DABARAN

Star: Red Giant

Known for: Home of the Dars, Atuta Shipyards, Dabaran Wine

Exports: Wine, Nobel gases, Luxuries

Imports: High technology, Medicine, Foods

Basking in the heat of its red star lies the planet of the Dars – Dabaran. The planet contains lush oasis gardens, extreme temperature variations, vast deserts, and a population with a soft spot for philosophy, mathematics, and beautiful mechanical creations. Dabaran is a binary system, but Dabaran-B (Exilion) is so small that it can hardly be spotted on its fast course past the gigantic Dabaran-A. The main star is a red giant with few satellites, but the rock planet Dabaran is the only one with a sizeable population. There are some gas mines on the enormous Salamanx and a research installation on the boiling hot Arara.

DABARAN-A OVERVIEW

Exilion: Dabaran's forgotten twin sun.

Arara: A boiling hot planet.

Dabaran: Home of the Dars.

Karbana: The Rock-Collectors Collective mine for minerals here.

Sumei: The isolated Consortium colony Jivos-3.

Mahmet: Desolate and haunted by Djinni.

Salamanx: Gas mines with introverted prospectors.

Yafir: Gas planet with argon deposits.

Marfuk: Dar Salamins telescope.

HOME OF THE DARS

The arid Dabaran is home to a flourishing class of nobles living in oasis gardens, domed palaces and ravine seraglios. Regardless of whether they are emirs, ferik, pashas or sultans, nobles should be addressed using the royal prefix "dar" or "dari", and the same term is used when speaking of their emirates. The dars are tangled up in a constant struggle to top one another in competitions of art, knowledge and wealth. The race for perfection takes on all sorts of forms, from intricate mosaics and palaces to shining, mechanical nightingales and owls. Dabaran was mostly spared the horrors of the Portal Wars. The planet was not hit by any major bombardment, and the dars had no fleets with which to engage in the fighting. Concentrated efforts instead went into securing the planet's self-sustainability, fortifying the oasis domes and stopping the spread of the contagious hate and suspicion that held the rest of the Horizon in a chokehold. In Lotus, the temple city, alliances and marriages were formed to safeguard the frail peace and further progress and enlightenment.

ZENITHIAN ARROGANCE

The Consortium, with Parr at the forefront, has started to take an interest in the rich soils of the lowlands. With permission from emir Karabah of Lotus, several multi-farms have been founded on the slopes of the Yeva Valley. Pumping stations and colossal crawlers are slowly taking over the valley – destroying

it, according to many – and this has resulted in dust storms sweeping out towards the neighboring dars. Rumors have it that the Zenithians are attempting to drill their way into the Wound, which is located just north of the Yeva Valley – why else would they have mobilized Parr-Nestera's attack brigades?

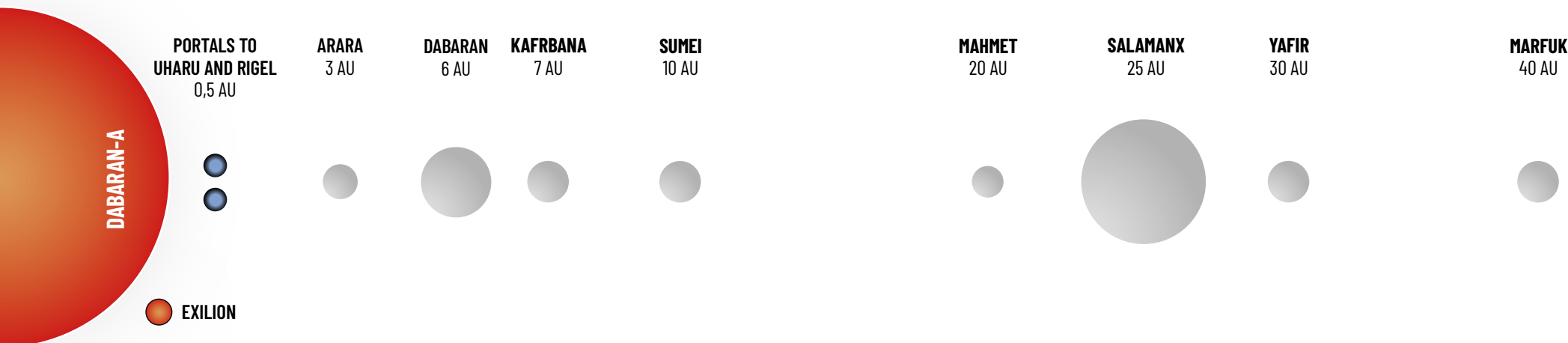
DABARAN CALM

The Dabarans are a calm and thoughtful people. It is not for nothing that the Circle of Seekers has their headquarters for the Horizon on Dabaran. For a while, the Seekers were on their way to becoming a faction, which would have given Dabaran a voice in interstellar politics, but this never came to be as large parts of the cult were assimilated into the Church of the Icons. The Dabarans nowadays work through the Church to get their voices heard, if they involve themselves at all. As long as the bulk haulers from Mira via Kua arrive, not many are bothered, however.

The Dabaran calm is also present in daily life – at least for the privileged. Art, mathematics, fine mechanics, and philosophy are valued highly.

THE PLANET ITSELF

Dabaran is a world full of contrasts – the lowlands are rich and warm, while the cold deserts in the highlands are almost sterile. The highlands experience extreme temperatures, and although the dars' climate reactors have increased the levels of greenhouse



gases in the atmosphere to even out the differences, they can still differ as much as 60 degrees Celsius between day and night. The summers are desert hot, and the winters are the opposite. The outer farmlands require sculpted crops or oasis domes.

The lowlands are warm and more even when it comes to temperature, with open palaces, cities and farms. The larger cities are located here, as well as the planet's only ocean.

THE IRON STORMS

The highlands are plagued at regular intervals by red iron storms, sometimes referred to as the "face of the Judge". In the iron-rich deserts, a ground charge builds up, pulling microscopic sand particles up into the atmosphere and then throwing them across the plains.

The charged particles find their way into every nook and cranny of vehicles and exos, and can even affect shuttle traffic departing for orbit. The storms sometimes last for days. The Mathematical Institute in Daddah regularly issues warning predictions about coming storms.

THE CLOUD CITY

The Shariqah emirate stands out from the other dars of Dabaran. Instead of constructing an oasis dome, emira Yossipa dari-Shariqah created a flying city called the Cloud City. The city floats above the equator of the planet on an elliptical base covered with several oasis domes. The Cloud City has become a focal point for gamblers among Dabaran's upper classes as well as from the rest of the Horizon. There are always grav racing, shah tournaments, and other events taking place here. The wealth of the Cloud City has attracted the attention of the Syndicate, which has established themselves here through intermediaries.

THE WOUND

To the nobles of Dabaran, Lotus is the Icons' capital on the planet. The city was constructed by the Seekers next to the mysterious Wound, a chasm whose volcanic depths are yet to be measured. The Wound is said to be of Portal Builder origin, but there are no obvious artifact finds in the area that could prove it. Several expeditions have disappeared in the darkness of the Wound. To settle the matter once and for all, the Foundation recently sent a team of xeno-archaeologists to the site.

LOTUS, THE TEMPLE CITY

To the Dars of Dabaran, Lotus is the religious capital. It lies on Mount Loti in the golden Taraa mountain range, just west of the mysterious Wound – a wide chasm whose volcanic depths have

yet to be explored. The city has existed as long as there have been written records on Dabaran, and several temples and chapels are cut directly into the yellow sandstone of the mountain.

In the great temple, covered by the Dome of the Icons, the Lotus Council convenes. Pilgrims from all over the Horizon gather on the square outside of the temple, having walked all the way from the space port of Bas Ghoura, since no spacecraft,

DAR BAHRI

The metropolis of the lowlands, on the beaches of the Bahri Sea, is Dabaran's unofficial hub. Lords and ladies come here to mingle, form pacts and settle disputes in the sun-drenched beach pavilions constructed by emir Rahmalan. The city stretches far into the distance above the beach promenade. White houses, villas and palaces are spread out among olive gardens, sculpted pine groves and cliff sides plummeting into the sea.

On the edges of the city, the luxury gives way to narrow alleys and small brown, red and whitewashed houses. The spaceport and the lodgings for the thousands of plebeians, who serve the masters of the city, are hidden behind the mountain, which the city lies on.

THE DABARI LION

Despite its name, the Dabari Lion is not a feline creature, but rather a domestic xenomorph of the Dabaran lowlands. It has a cat-like head with a mane of fine tentacles used for communication and mating. Skin-clad bone plates protrude from the spine, like a jagged mountain range. The lions hunt in packs and sometimes target caravans or sneak into servant cities to snatch human prey. In spite of this, the species is protected and only exalted emirs and their equals may hunt them. The mane-tentacles are said to improve one's senses when ingested, making them expensive on the black market controlled by poachers from the Syndicate.

HOME OF THE DJINNI

Nowhere in the Third Horizon are Djinni as well regarded as on Dabaran. Here, Djinni are perceived as good – or at least neutral. Dabaran myth and legend is full of tales about a Djinn safely leading wanderers and caravans to their destination, protecting the weak, or averting diseases.

Oasis domes, palaces, seraglios and souks all feature small altars where one can present gifts to the local Djinn. The Djinni exists in several forms on Dabaran, from the animalistic Nasah to the human-like Silah and Safrah. Silah are house-djinni who often hide in harems or cloisters, often in the form of a beautiful

and intelligent concubine or prophet. According to folklore, they protect their dwelling and their master against ill fortune and evil spirits. Safrah are tricksters who live in bazaars and markets where they protect against ill-fortune, but also cause mischief.

